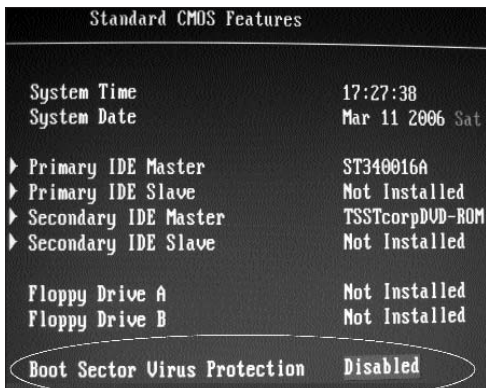


viruses would change the boot sector causing the OS to not start at all. To prevent this, BIOSes have an option by which no program is allowed to write to the boot sector. If such an attempt is made, the BIOS either flashes a warning message or disallows the modification outright. Therefore, while installing any OS, this option has to be disabled.

Look for this option in the Standard CMOS (or BIOS) Settings or Advanced CMOS (or BIOS) Settings and disable it. Save this setting. Remember, don't change anything else in your BIOS !

Most new distributions have an installer (Anaconda, mostly) that provide you with an easy interface during installation. You can use the mouse during installation to choose between the different options. But there are some distributions such



Standard CMOS Features	
System Time	17:27:38
System Date	Mar 11 2006 Sat
▶ Primary IDE Master	ST340016A
▶ Primary IDE Slave	Not Installed
▶ Secondary IDE Master	TSSTcorpDVD-ROM
▶ Secondary IDE Slave	Not Installed
Floppy Drive A	Not Installed
Floppy Drive B	Not Installed
Boot Sector Virus Protection	Disabled

Check that this setting is Disabled

as Ubuntu which only offer the keyboard interface. But this is no reason to get alarmed! Using *[Tab]*, the arrow keys and *[Enter]*, you can accomplish everything with ease. In fact, the number of times you need to interact with the computer during the installation is comparable to a Windows install.

2.1.5 Installation

Once you boot from the CD, you will see a welcome message and a logo of the version, which varies according to the distribution. The installer runs some pre-install checks to ensure compatibility—this takes just a few minutes. Once the preliminary checks are done with, you will typically be asked to choose from the available free